Safe Use of Household Cleaning Products (Public Health Guidance Summary)

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Access	Field representatives and regional managers
Status	draft for team review
Source	Public guidance: U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, MMWR 69(23), 2020; U.S. federal government work

This is a summary written in Team 1's own words for the Marvel CPG capstone knowledge base. It is not a copy of the original. Read the original source for full details; cite the original, not this summary, in any formal work.

1 Source

Gharpure, R., Hunter, C.M., Schnall, A.H., et al. (2020). Knowledge and Practices Regarding Safe Household Cleaning and Disinfection for COVID-19 Prevention — United States, May 2020. *Morbidity and Mortality Weekly Report (MMWR)*, 69(23), 705-709. U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC). https://doi.org/10.15585/mmwr.mm6923e2 (https://www.cdc.gov/mmwr/volumes/69/wr/mm6923e2.htm)

MMWR is published by a U.S. federal agency. This document summarises its findings and recommendations in Team 1's words.

2 What the survey found

CDC ran an online panel survey of 502 U.S. adults in May 2020 about how they clean and disinfect at home.

- **Knowledge gaps:** only 58% of respondents knew that bleach should not be mixed with ammonia, and only 35% knew that bleach should not be mixed with vinegar. 23% knew that only room-temperature water should be used to dilute bleach.
- **Risky practices:** 39% reported at least one high-risk practice, such as using bleach on food items (19%) or applying household cleaners or disinfectants to bare skin (18%).
- **Health effects:** 25% reported at least one adverse health effect in the previous month that they believed came from using cleaners or disinfectants.

3 Safe-use recommendations

The report recommends communicating these safe practices:

- **Read and follow the label instructions** on every product.
- **Use room-temperature water** to dilute bleach, unless the label says otherwise.
- **Never mix products.** Mixing bleach with vinegar or with ammonia can release chlorine or chloramine gases, which can severely damage the lungs when inhaled.
- **Ventilate the room** while cleaning.
- **Protect skin and eyes:** wear gloves, and consider eye protection where splashes are possible.
- **Store products out of reach of children and pets**, including hand sanitisers.
- **Do not use cleaning or disinfectant products on skin or food**, and never swallow, inhale or gargle them.

4 How Marvel field teams should use this guidance

- When a shopper or store owner asks whether two Marvel products can be used together, the answer is: **never mix cleaning products**. This applies especially to Bleach Clean White and any other cleaner, including the Heavy-Duty Degreaser (MCPG-01).
- Point to the product label for dilution, use and protective equipment.
- Store displays should keep cleaning products away from food and out of children's reach where possible.
- Representatives are not medical advisers. For an exposure, direct the person to the product label and to a poison control centre or emergency medical help.

5 Limitations

- The survey used a non-probability online panel, so the percentages describe that sample, not the whole U.S. population.
- The report was written for COVID-19 prevention, but its safe-use recommendations apply to household cleaning products in general.

Document control

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Open points and review notes

- Summary written by Team 1; figures and recommendations checked against the report on 20 October 2026.